

World War I was a global conflict originating in Europe that lasted from July 28, 1914, to November 11, 1918. The conflict was triggered by the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand of Austria in Sarajevo by Gavrilo Princip. The war involved two major opposing coalitions: the Allied Powers (primarily France, Great Britain, Russia, Italy, Japan, and later the United States) and the Central Powers (Germany, Austria-Hungary, and the Ottoman Empire).

Much of the fighting on the Western Front was characterized by brutal trench warfare, a deadlock stretching from the Swiss border to the North Sea. New military technologies—including machine guns, poison gas, armored tanks, and combat aircraft—were deployed at scale for the first time, resulting in over 20 million deaths.

The conflict concluded following the collapse of the Central Powers and the armistice signed on November 11, 1918. The signing of the Treaty of Versailles in 1919 officially ended the state of war between Germany and the Allied Powers, redrawing national boundaries across Europe and establishing the League of Nations to preserve international peace.